

Everything SATS — Reading Mock 2

Reading booklet

This is an original practice paper written for Everything SATS. It follows the layout and question types of the real Key Stage 2 English reading test, but it is **not** a real past paper.

There are three texts in this booklet:

1. The Kite on Bramble Hill
2. The Map in the Library Book
3. Rivers of Ice

Print this booklet and the question booklet. Read one text, answer its questions, then move on to the next text.

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The Kite on Bramble Hill

In this poem, a child and their grandad fly a kite on a windy hill.

We climbed the hill at the edge of town,
where the grass grows long and the wind blows down,
my grandad puffing, his cheeks like plums,
me with the kite and my frozen thumbs.

It lay in my arms like a sleeping thing,
all folded paper and knotted string,
a diamond of scarlet, a tail of blue,
waiting to learn what the sky could do.

I lifted the kite and I held it high,
my eyes on the clouds in the slate-grey sky.
'Now wait,' said Grandad, 'and feel the air.
The wind will tell you when it's there.'
I stood so still that I heard it hum,
a low, deep note like a distant drum.

Then all at once the gust arrived:
it snatched the kite and the kite came alive!
It leapt from my hands like a startled bird;
it tugged and it twisted, it bucked and it whirred.

Up past the oak and the chimney pots,
up past the gulls in their squabbling knots,
till the town below was a toybox spilled
and the whole wide sky was a page unfilled.

A dog down there ran round in rings,
the washing waved on a hundred strings,
and people stopped in the street to stare
at the small red bird that was dancing there.

The string sang tight between us two,
a thread of wonder, taut and true.
I felt the pull of the clouds and the sun,
as if the sky and I were one.

When evening came and the wind grew thin,
we wound the kite in, slowly, slowly in.
It drifted down like a tired leaf
and landed soft on the grass beneath.

We walked back home as the light turned gold,
my fingers stiff and my nose red with cold,
but under my coat, where no one could see,
the sky was still tugging, tugging at me.

The Map in the Library Book

In this story, Millie and her brother William make a surprising discovery during the half-term holiday.

By Tuesday of the half-term holiday, Millie had run out of things to do. She had tidied her shelves, finished her jigsaw and taught the dog to shake hands, although he still offered the wrong paw. Her brother William was even worse off. He had spent the whole morning lying upside down on the sofa, sighing so loudly that Dad finally lost patience.

'Right, you two,' Dad said, reaching for his coat. 'Library. Now. Before you both turn into furniture.'

The village library was small and smelled of polish and old paper. Mrs Okafor, the librarian, waved at them from behind a tower of returned books. Millie headed straight for the history shelves, where the books were so old that their covers had faded to the colour of weak tea. She pulled out one called *Our Village Through the Years* and let it fall open on the table.

Something slid out from between the pages and fluttered to the floor.

William pounced on it. It was a sheet of paper, folded into quarters, soft and yellow at the edges. When he opened it, both children leaned in so close that their heads bumped.

It was a map. Someone had drawn it in careful pencil: the village green, the duck pond, the church with its pointed spire and, at the very top, their own school. Beside the school was a small square labelled 'garden', and in the middle of the garden was a neat black cross. Underneath, in wobbly capital letters, someone had written: **FOR THE FUTURE.**

'Treasure,' breathed William.

'Don't be silly,' said Millie, but her heart was thumping. 'It's probably just a game someone made up.' Even as she said it, she was studying the cross, trying to work out exactly where it was.

They took the map to the desk. Mrs Okafor put on her glasses and examined it for a long time. 'Well, I never,' she said at last. 'This book hasn't been borrowed for years.'

Whoever drew this must have tucked it inside a very long time ago.' She tapped the corner of the paper. 'Look here.'

In the corner, so faint that they had almost missed it, were the words: Class 6, Mr Bell.

'Mr Bell was the head teacher here long before my time,' said Mrs Okafor, smiling. 'My mother used to talk about him. So this map is older than I am.'

Walking home, William could talk about nothing else. Pirates, gold coins, a lost crown, a secret tunnel: every few steps he thought of something new. Millie said nothing at all. She was thinking about the school. There was no garden there now, only the playground, the field and the scruffy patch behind the kitchens where the old sundial stood. The sundial! She stopped so suddenly that Dad almost walked into her.

'The cross isn't in the middle of a garden,' she said slowly. 'It's in the middle of the sundial patch. That must have been the garden once.'

The next morning, Dad telephoned the school, and by ten o'clock they were standing beside the sundial with Mr Pike, the caretaker, who had brought a spade and a great deal of curiosity. 'Thirty years I've looked after this school,' he said, 'and nobody has ever mentioned buried treasure to me.'

He dug carefully, a little to the left of the sundial, where the cross on the map seemed to point. The soil was dark and heavy. Millie held her breath each time the spade went in. William hopped from one foot to the other. After a while, Mr Pike's forehead was shiny with sweat and the hole was knee-deep, and still there was nothing.

'Maybe it was just a game after all,' William said in a small voice.

Then the spade struck something with a dull clunk.

Mr Pike knelt down and brushed away the earth with his hands. Slowly, he lifted out a biscuit tin, its lid rusted shut and its painted roses almost worn away. It took all three of them, and the end of a teaspoon, to prise it open.

There were no gold coins inside. Instead, there was a class photograph in black and white, a handful of marbles, a comic with a price on the front that made Dad laugh out loud, and a bundle of letters tied with string. On top lay a note: To whoever finds this, we hope the future is kind to you. Please look after our treasures.

'It's a time capsule,' Millie whispered. Somehow, it was better than gold. It was a message from children who had once sat in their classroom and played on their field.

William was flicking through the letters. Suddenly, he went very still. 'Millie,' he said. 'Look at this name.'

The letter was written in round, careful handwriting. At the bottom it said: From Rosie Hale, aged 10.

Millie stared at it. Rosie Hale was the name written inside Gran's old recipe book, the name Gran had before she married Grandpa.

That afternoon, they carried the tin to Gran's house as carefully as if it were made of glass. Gran unfolded the letter, and for a long moment she said nothing at all. Then she began to laugh and cry at the same time.

'I wrote that I wanted to be an astronaut,' she said, wiping her eyes. 'And that I hoped whoever found it would take good care of it.' She squeezed both their hands. 'I never dreamed it would be my own grandchildren.'

That evening, Millie sat down at the kitchen table with a clean sheet of paper and a sharp pencil. At the top of the page, in her very best handwriting, she wrote: To whoever finds this...

Rivers of Ice

This text explains how glaciers form, how they shape the land and why they are changing.

Imagine a river that flows so slowly that you could watch it all day and never see it move. Now imagine that this river is made not of water but of solid ice, sometimes hundreds of metres thick, grinding its way through the mountains. This is a glacier, and although it seems frozen in place, it is one of the most powerful forces on our planet.

What is a glacier?

A glacier is an enormous mass of ice that forms on land and moves slowly under its own weight. Glaciers are found in the coldest parts of the world, such as Antarctica and Greenland, where vast sheets of ice cover most of the land. They are also found high in mountain ranges such as the Alps and the Himalayas, where the air stays cold all year round.

How is a glacier made?

Every glacier begins as snow. In places where more snow falls in winter than melts in summer, the snow does not disappear. Instead, it builds up, layer upon layer, year after year.

As the pile grows deeper, the weight of the new snow presses down on the older snow beneath. The delicate, feathery snowflakes are crushed together and the air trapped between them is slowly squeezed out. Gradually, the snow turns into hard, grainy crystals, and then into solid ice. This change is extremely slow: it can take many years, even centuries, for fresh snow to become true glacier ice.

Glacier ice is so dense that it often looks a deep blue. This is because thick ice soaks up some of the other colours in sunlight, so that mostly blue light reaches our eyes.

Can ice really move?

Once a glacier becomes thick and heavy enough, gravity begins to pull it downhill. It might seem impossible for something as solid as ice to flow, but under enormous pressure, the ice deep inside a glacier slowly bends and changes shape, rather like

very thick toffee on a warm day. At the same time, a thin layer of meltwater can form underneath the glacier, helping it to slide over the rock below.

Most glaciers creep forward far too slowly for anyone to notice. However, over months and years, the distance adds up. The ice at the surface is more brittle and cannot bend as easily as the ice deep below. As the glacier moves, this top layer often cracks open, forming deep splits called crevasses. Some are so deep that you cannot see the bottom.

Sculptors of the land

As a glacier moves, it does not simply slide over the landscape: it reshapes it. Water from melting ice trickles into cracks in the rock beneath the glacier and then freezes again, loosening chunks of rock. The glacier plucks these rocks away and carries them along, frozen into its base. Dragged along the ground, they act like giant sandpaper, scraping and grinding the rock below.

This has a dramatic effect on valleys. A river usually cuts a narrow, V-shaped valley. When a glacier squeezes through that same valley, it scours away the sides and the floor, widening and deepening it. By the time the ice has gone, the valley has been carved into a broad U shape, with steep sides and a wide, flat floor.

Glaciers also act like colossal conveyor belts. They carry rocks, gravel and sand, sometimes for many miles, and drop them where the ice melts. Walkers sometimes find huge boulders sitting alone on a hillside, made of a completely different type of rock from the ground around them. These stones are called erratics.

Britain's frozen past

It is hard to picture today, but much of Britain was once buried under ice. During the last ice age, which ended more than ten thousand years ago, great sheets of ice and glaciers covered Scotland, much of Wales and a large part of northern England. Southern England escaped the ice, but it was still bitterly cold.

The evidence of this icy past is all around us. In the Lake District, many of the valleys have the unmistakable U shape carved by glaciers, and several of the famous lakes lie in deep hollows that the ice gouged out. In the Scottish Highlands, glaciers carved out wide glens and deep lochs. There are no glaciers left in the UK now, but in a sense, the ice is still with us: it shaped the very ground beneath our feet.

Why are glaciers shrinking?

A glacier is a little like a bank account. Snow falling in winter adds to it, while melting in summer takes away from it. If the two stay roughly balanced, the glacier stays about the same size. But if more ice melts each summer than is replaced by snow, the glacier begins to shrink. It becomes thinner, and its lower end retreats back up the valley.

Today, most of the world's glaciers are shrinking. Scientists who compare old photographs with modern ones can see that some glaciers have pulled back a long way, leaving bare, rocky valleys where there was once thick ice. The main reason is that the Earth's climate is warming, largely because of the gases released when people burn coal, oil and gas.

This matters for many reasons. In some parts of the world, meltwater from mountain glaciers feeds the rivers that people rely on for drinking water and for watering their crops. As glaciers disappear, these rivers could run lower in hot, dry summers. Meltwater also flows into the oceans, adding to rising sea levels.

Glaciers have been shaping our planet for millions of years, slowly and silently. Whether they survive into the future depends, in part, on the choices that people make today.